

D766

Considerations for Instructional Planning for Learners

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A special education teacher's pacing guide says to move on to two-digit subtraction next week. A student with a learning disability solves two-digit addition with regrouping at 60% accuracy. The mastery criterion is 90% across three sessions, and the school has a new math coach. What should the teacher do?

- A. Move on after one session at 90%.
- B. Ask the new coach to teach it instead.
- C. Keep teaching addition with regrouping until he meets 90% across three sessions.
- D. Move on, since the pacing guide says to.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student's criterion is 90% across three consecutive sessions. Her scores: 92%, 85%, 91%, 94%, 90%. Has she met mastery?

- A. Yes, after the very first session.
- B. Yes, the last three sessions were all at or above 90%.
- C. No, because 90% does not count as meeting 90%.
- D. No, because she scored 85% once.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

3.

A fourth grader in a Tier 2 reading group of six has made little progress for eight weeks. The group meets 30 minutes three times a week. The program has bright workbooks, and the student's older cousin went through the same program. Which change is a sound way to intensify?

- A. Reduce the group to two students and increase sessions to five days a week, then monitor data.
- B. Keep everything the same for another eight weeks.
- C. Use the same workbooks his cousin used.
- D. Switch to a new program every two weeks until one works.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student's intervention grows from 30 minutes, 3 days a week, to 40 minutes, 5 days a week. How many more minutes per week is that?

- A.** 290 minutes
- B.** 10 minutes
- C.** 200 minutes
- D.** 110 minutes

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A student with autism learned to greet his special education teacher by name, but he does not greet anyone else. The resource room has a blue door and a class fish tank. What should the teacher do?

- A.** Move practice by the fish tank.
- B.** Keep practicing only with the special education teacher.
- C.** Practice greetings with many adults and peers in several settings.
- D.** Decide he cannot generalize skills.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A sixth grader with ADHD is often off task during independent work. His teacher wants him to rely less on reminders. The class has 25 students and a new reading series. Which plan uses self-monitoring?

- A.** When a quiet timer vibrates, he marks yes or no for "Was I working?" and compares the total to his goal.
- B.** The teacher records his on-task behavior every five minutes.
- C.** Give more frequent verbal reminders.
- D.** Move him to a smaller class.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A teacher shows one example of finding the main idea, then gives a worksheet to do alone. Most students with IEPs get it wrong. The class meets right after lunch and uses a document camera. What was left out?

- A. Teaching before lunch.
- B. A second independent practice session.
- C. A longer worksheet.
- D. Guided practice with feedback before independent work.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

Students with learning disabilities can recite the steps of a paraphrasing strategy but never use it during science reading. The school has a new science lab and a 20-minute homeroom. What should the teacher add?

- A. Require the strategy on every text forever.
- B. Use the new science lab for extra time.
- C. Have them memorize the steps more quickly.
- D. Teach when and why the strategy helps, and practice choosing it with different texts.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A student's last five weekly reading scores are 22, 23, 22, 21, 23, all below the goal line. The intervention room was recently repainted and the student has a new backpack. What should the teacher do?

- A. Change the instruction, such as adjusting intensity or focus, and keep monitoring.
- B. Keep the same plan until the end of the year.
- C. Wait until the student adjusts to the new room.
- D. Raise the goal line.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student's last four data points are all above the goal line. What decision fits?

- A.** Collect four more points before any decision.
- B.** Raise the goal.
- C.** End all support.
- D.** Change the intervention.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A teacher spends one full week drilling long division, then moves on. Six weeks later, most students with IEPs cannot do it. The school has a new bell schedule and students take tests on laptops. What should the teacher change?

- A.** Test on paper instead of laptops.
- B.** Build in short, spaced reviews of long division mixed with newer skills over the following weeks.
- C.** Drill long division for two full weeks next time.
- D.** Stop teaching long division since students forget.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which practice schedule is most likely to lead to long-term retention of vocabulary?

- A.** One 140-minute session the day before the test.
- B.** Practice only the newest words each day.
- C.** Ten minutes a day across two weeks with mixed review of earlier words.
- D.** Practice each word once and never again.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A special education teacher's pacing guide says to move on to two-digit subtraction next week. A student with a learning disability solves two-digit addition with regrouping at 60% accuracy. The mastery criterion is 90% across three sessions, ~~and the school has a new math coach~~. What should the teacher do?

Target word: move on or reteach **Decides:** 60% is below the 90% criterion.

A	Dropped element	Drops the three-session requirement.
B	Camouflage	Who teaches does not decide whether mastery is met.
C	Correct	Mastery comes before new skills that build on it.
D	Inverted operation	Lets the calendar override the data.

2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

A student's criterion is 90% across three consecutive sessions. Her scores: 92%, 85%, 91%, 94%, 90%. Has she met mastery?

Target word: check a mastery criterion **Decides:** Last three sessions are 91%, 94%, 90%, all $\geq 90\%$.

A	Dropped element	One session does not meet a three-session criterion.
B	Correct	91, 94, and 90 are three consecutive sessions at criterion.
C	Confusion set	90% meets a criterion of 90%.
D	Absolute language	The earlier dip does not break the later streak.

3. Answer A Concept 2

A fourth grader in a Tier 2 reading group of six has made little progress for eight weeks. The group meets 30 minutes three times a week. ~~The program has bright workbooks, and the student's older cousin went through the same program.~~ Which change is a sound way to intensify?

Target word: intensification **Decides:** Adjust a dimension such as group size or dosage based on data.

A	Correct	Smaller group size and more dosage are standard intensification dimensions.
B	Dropped element	No dimension is changed despite poor response.
C	Camouflage	Family history does not decide the next step.
D	Inverted operation	Random switching prevents judging any change.

4. Answer D Concept 2 • transfer

A student's intervention grows from 30 minutes, 3 days a week, to 40 minutes, 5 days a week. How many more minutes per week is that?

Target word: compute dosage change **Decides:** $200 - 90 = 110$.

A	Inverted operation	Adds the two totals instead of subtracting.
B	Wrong stem number	The change in session length only.
C	Dropped element	The new total, not the increase.
D	Correct	$40 \times 5 = 200$; $30 \times 3 = 90$; $200 - 90 = 110$.

5. Answer C Concept 3

A student with autism learned to greet his special education teacher by name, but he does not greet anyone else. ~~The resource room has a blue door and a class fish tank.~~ What should the teacher do?

Target word: promote generalization **Decides:** The skill was taught with only one person and setting.

A	Camouflage	The same room and person remain.
B	Dropped element	More of the same single exemplar will not generalize.
C	Correct	Multiple exemplars and settings promote transfer.
D	Absolute language	Generalization can be taught.

6. Answer A Concept 4

A sixth grader with ADHD is often off task during independent work. His teacher wants him to rely less on reminders. ~~The class has 25 students and a new reading series.~~ Which plan uses self-monitoring?

Target word: self-monitoring plan **Decides:** The student records his own behavior against a goal.

A	Correct	The student observes and records his own behavior.
B	Inverted operation	Teacher tracking does not build self-management.
C	Adjacent category	Increases reliance on adult prompts.
D	Camouflage	Class size is not the self-monitoring component.

7. Answer D Concept 5

A teacher shows one example of finding the main idea, then gives a worksheet to do alone. Most students with IEPs get it wrong. ~~The class meets right after lunch and uses a document camera.~~ What was left out?

Target word: missing explicit-instruction step **Decides:** No guided practice with feedback.

A	Camouflage	Time of day is not the missing step.
B	Dropped element	Still skips guided practice.
C	Inverted operation	More independent work repeats the problem.
D	Correct	The “we do” step lets the teacher catch and correct errors.

8. Answer D Concept 6

Students with learning disabilities can recite the steps of a paraphrasing strategy but never use it during science reading. ~~The school has a new science lab and a 20-minute homeroom.~~ What should the teacher add?

Target word: what makes strategies transfer **Decides:** They lack knowledge of when and why to use it.

A	Absolute language	Students should learn to choose it when it fits.
B	Camouflage	A new room does not teach strategy use.
C	Dropped element	They already know the steps.
D	Correct	Conditional knowledge lets students decide to use the strategy on their own.

9. Answer A Concept 7

A student's last five weekly reading scores are 22, 23, 22, 21, 23, all below the goal line. ~~The intervention room was recently repainted and the student has a new backpack.~~ What should the teacher do?

Target word: decision from flat data **Decides:** Flat trend below the aimline.

A	Correct	Data below the goal line with a flat trend call for a change.
B	Inverted operation	Waiting wastes weeks of instruction.
C	Camouflage	Room changes do not explain five flat weeks.
D	Adjacent category	Raising goals applies when data are above the line.

10. Answer B Concept 7 • transfer

A student's last four data points are all above the goal line. What decision fits?

Target word: decision when data are above **Decides:** Consistently above the aimline = raise the goal.

A	Dropped element	The decision rule is already met.
B	Correct	Data above the line show the goal is too low.
C	Absolute language	Doing well does not mean supports should stop at once.
D	Inverted operation	That is the response to data below the line.

11. Answer B Concept 8

A teacher spends one full week drilling long division, then moves on. Six weeks later, most students with IEPs cannot do it. ~~The school has a new bell schedule and students take tests on laptops.~~ What should the teacher change?

Target word: retention strategy **Decides:** Massed practice without later review.

A	Camouflage	The test format does not explain forgetting.
B	Correct	Spaced, cumulative review supports long-term retention.
C	Inverted operation	More massed practice still lacks spacing.
D	Absolute language	Forgetting is addressed by review, not by dropping the skill.

12. Answer C Concept 8 • transfer

Which practice schedule is most likely to lead to long-term retention of vocabulary?

Target word: spaced vs. massed **Decides:** Spread practice with review.

A	Inverted operation	Massed cramming fades quickly.
B	Adjacent category	Spaced but not cumulative; earlier words fade.
C	Correct	Spaced and cumulative practice improves retention.
D	Dropped element	No review at all.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	9	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	3	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	1	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	8	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Teaching to mastery	Set a clear mastery criterion (for example, 90% accuracy across three sessions) and keep teaching a skill until the student meets it before moving on.	Moving on when the unit calendar says so, or after one good day.	A pacing guide pushes the next skill while data show partial accuracy.
2	Dimensions of intensification	Intensify intervention by changing dosage (time, frequency), group size, explicitness, practice opportunities, feedback, or alignment to the specific deficit, one change at a time and guided by data.	Intensifying by giving the same program to the student for longer with no other change, or by switching programs randomly.	A student is not responding to a standard intervention.
3	Programming for generalization	Teach with multiple examples, settings, materials, and people so a skill transfers beyond the teaching situation.	Teaching with one worksheet and one adult and assuming the skill will appear elsewhere.	A skill works in the resource room but not in other classes.
4	Self-monitoring	Students observe and record their own behavior or performance against a goal, which builds independence and often improves the behavior itself.	Having the teacher do all tracking and expecting students to self-manage.	A goal to increase on-task or work completion with less adult prompting.
5	Explicit instruction sequence	State the goal, model clearly (I do), guide practice with feedback (we do), then independent practice (you do), checking understanding throughout.	Moving from a quick model straight to independent work.	Students fail independent work right after a demonstration.
6	Conditional knowledge in strategy instruction	Strategy instruction must teach when and why to use a strategy, not only its steps, so students choose it on their own.	Teaching strategy steps without discussing when they help.	Students can list steps but never use the strategy unprompted.
7	Acting on flat progress data	When several data points fall below the goal line or the trend is flat, change instruction instead of waiting.	Continuing the same plan hoping growth will appear.	A graph with a flat trend below the aimline.
8	Spaced practice and cumulative review	Practice spread over time and mixed review of earlier skills build long-term retention better than massed practice on one skill.	Drilling one skill in one long block and never returning to it.	Students master a skill but lose it weeks later.

Course scope (public description): Considerations for Instructional Planning for Learners is designed to introduce special education teachers to a repertoire of evidence-based instructional strategies to advance the learning of students with exceptionalities. The course focuses specifically on strategies for intensifying and individualizing instructional interventions; making instructional decisions based on progress- monitoring data; collaborating with general education teachers and paraprofessionals; teaching to mastery; promoting

generalization of learning; and teaching students with exceptionalities how to use self-assessment, problem solving, and other cognitive strategies to organize critical content and meet their needs.